

# The European Job Search Checklist

*What recruiters actually check before they call you. 12 things most international applicants miss.*

---

## 01 Work authorization is stated, not implied

“Open to relocation” is not the same as stating clearly whether you need sponsorship. Say it in one direct line, on the CV and on LinkedIn.

## 02 Language levels are honest and matched to the market

Recruiters check the local language requirement before anything else for client-facing or internal-facing roles. An inflated level gets caught in the first phone call.

## 03 No unexplained employment gaps

A gap without a line of context reads as inactivity, even when you were studying, relocating, or building something. One sentence closes the question before it's asked.

## 04 No overlapping dates without explanation

Two full-time roles, or a business and a job, running in the same window will stop a recruiter cold unless it's clearly labelled as part-time, freelance, or a side project.

## 05 Job titles match everywhere

CV, LinkedIn, and what you say out loud should all agree. A title upgrade that isn't backed by the experience section undermines trust fast.

## 06 One clear direction, not three

A CV built for three different career paths at once usually convinces a recruiter of none of them. Pick the lead story; mention the rest in conversation.

## 07 Format survives an ATS

Two-column layouts, text boxes, and icons can lose information when parsed. Single column, standard fonts, and clear headings parse cleanly.

## 08 No leftover internal markers

“Confidential” or “Not for external distribution” footers pulled from an old employer's template raise a compliance flag before anyone reads a word.

## 09 Achievements, not just duties

“Responsible for reporting” tells a recruiter nothing. “Cut reporting time by 30% across six teams” tells them exactly what you're worth.

## 10 Specific expertise is visible, not buried

Named brands, named certifications, named technical processes belong near the top. If it's only in a bullet three roles down, it isn't doing its job.

## 11 LinkedIn and CV actually align, and links work

A broken LinkedIn link or a profile that contradicts the CV is one of the fastest ways to lose credibility with almost no effort to fix.

## **12 No personal details recruiters don't need**

Date of birth, marital status, and a photo you're unsure about can invite bias or trip ATS systems, depending on the market. When in doubt, leave it out.

---

### **Want an honest, specific read on your own CV against this list?**

Reach out at [noelia@landineuropecoaching.com](mailto:noelia@landineuropecoaching.com) or visit [landineuropecoaching.com](https://landineuropecoaching.com).

*Noelia Teruel Ortega — Land in Europe Coaching*